

YOUR ICP IS NOT “B2B SAAS, 50 TO 500 EMPLOYEES.” THAT'S A SEARCH FILTER.

Search · People

Filters (3)

Industry: B2B SaaS ×

Headcount: 50-500 ×

Title: VP Sales ×

148,212 results



Acme Cloud

B2B SaaS · 120

VP Sales

fits?



Northwind

B2B SaaS · 140

VP Sales

fits?



Beacon Labs

B2B SaaS · 68

VP Sales

fits?



Halcyon

B2B SaaS · 320

VP Sales

fits?

.. 148,206 more, all identical to the filter

148,212 companies. Maybe 900 will ever buy. The filter can't tell you which.

SWIPE →



Vesselin Malev

Founder, The Demand Department

THE TEST

READ YOUR ICP TO A STRANGER. CAN THEY NAME **THREE** **COMPANIES IN IT?**

YOU SAY

“Mid-market B2B SaaS companies looking to scale their outbound.”



STRANGER 1

“Uh.. Salesforce?”



STRANGER 2

“Any of them? All of them?”



STRANGER 3

“That's not a company, that's a category.”

If a stranger can't name three, **your list builder can't either.** It just doesn't tell you.



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Founder, The Demand Department

THE SENTENCE

A REAL ICP FITS IN ONE SENTENCE WITH FOUR BLANKS.

We help *a specific person* at
a specific kind of company who is
dealing with
a specific, observable problem,
because
a specific trigger just happened.

PERSON

a title with budget and a
pager

COMPANY

a shape, not a category

PROBLEM

visible from the outside

TRIGGER

happened in the last 90
days



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FILLED IN

HERE'S ONE THAT BOOKS MEETINGS.

*We help **heads of sales** at **Series A SaaS** companies with **3 to 8 reps** who are missing pipeline targets while reps write **their own emails**, because they just posted their first SDR job.*

SEARCH FILTER

148,212

companies

THE SENTENCE

412

companies, this quarter

REPLY RATE

9.6%

vs 0.8% on the filter



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IF YOU CAN'T SEE THE PROBLEM FROM OUTSIDE, YOU CAN'T BUILD A LIST FOR IT.

INVISIBLE FROM OUTSIDE

~~"wants to grow revenue"~~

~~"struggling with efficiency"~~

~~"cares about quality"~~

true of everyone. filterable by no one.

VISIBLE FROM OUTSIDE

3 SDR roles open,
0 sales tools in
stack

JOBS + TECH

pricing page
changed twice this
quarter

SITE DIFF

founder posting
about pipeline
weekly

LINKEDIN

each one is a column Clay can fill.



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Founder, The Demand Department

BLANK 4 • THE TRIGGER

“WHO” GETS YOU A LIST. “WHY NOW” GETS YOU A REPLY.

clay

icp_q3 • sorted by trigger date

COMPANY	REPS	TRIGGER	AGE
Northwind	6	first SDR job posted	4d
Halcyon	4	new VP Sales, ex-Gong	11d
Larkspur	7	Series A announced	19d
Meridian	5	outbound tool churned	40d
Sterling	8	fits, no trigger	-
Oriel	3	fits, no trigger	-
trigger < 90 days → sequence now		fits, no trigger → watch list	



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WHAT THE SENTENCE DOES DOWNSTREAM

ONE SENTENCE WRITES THE LIST, THE OPENER **AND THE POST.**

THE LIST

```
reps 3-8 · stage = Series A · job_posted(SDR) < 90d ·  
sales_tools = 0
```

THE OPENER

“First SDR hire with six reps still writing their own sequences usually means the next quarter is already at risk.”

THE POST

“The week you post your first SDR job is the week your reps' email habits become expensive.”

THE LOOP

Same 412 companies see the post, get the email, meet the same name. **The sentence is the system.**



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WRITE YOURS TONIGHT. FOUR BLANKS, ONE SENTENCE, ZERO ADJECTIVES.

We help _____ *at* _____

who are _____, *because*

_____.

a title, not a persona

a shape with numbers

visible from outside

happened < 90 days ago



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